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Funke, Schularick, and Trebesch (2023)

Populist Leaders and the Economy

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Table 1: Populist Government Episodes, 1900–2020

Table 1—Populist Government Episodes, 1900–2020

Panel A. Populist leader spell (coded dataset)				
No.	Country	Years	Leader	Left/Right
1.	Argentina	1916–1922	Yrigoyen	Left-wing
2.	Argentina	1928–1930	Yrigoyen	Left-wing
3.	Argentina	1946–1955	Perón	Left-wing
4.	Argentina	1973–1974	Perón	Left-wing
5.	Argentina	1974–1976	Martínez de Perón	Left-wing
6.	Argentina	1989–1999	Menem	Right-wing
7.	Argentina	2003–2007	Kirchner	Left-wing
8.	Argentina	2007–2015	Fernández	Left-wing
9.	Bolivia	1952–1956	Estenssoro	Left-wing
10.	Bolivia	1956–1960	Zuazo	Left-wing
11.	Bolivia	1960–1964	Estenssoro	Left-wing
12.	Bolivia	2006–2019	Morales	Left-wing
13.	Brazil	1930–1945	Vargas	Left-wing
14.	Brazil	1951–1954	Vargas	Left-wing
15.	Brazil	1990–1992	Collor	Right-wing
16.	Brazil	2019–	Bolsonaro	Right-wing
17.	Bulgaria	2009–2013	Borisov	Right-wing
18.	Bulgaria	2014–2017	Borisov	Right-wing
19.	Bulgaria	2017–	Borisov	Right-wing
20.	Chile	1920–1924	Alessandri	Left-wing
21.	Chile	within 1925	Ibáñez	Left-wing
22.	Chile	within 1925	Alessandri	Left-wing
23.	Chile	1927–1931	Ibáñez	Left-wing
24.	Chile	1932–1938	Alessandri	Left-wing
25.	Chile	1952–1958	Ibáñez	Left-wing
26.	Ecuador	1934–1935	Velasco	Right-wing
27.	Ecuador	1944–1947	Velasco	Right-wing
28.	Ecuador	1952–1956	Velasco	Right-wing
29.	Ecuador	1960–1961	Velasco	Right-wing
30.	Ecuador	1968–1972	Velasco	Right-wing
31.	Ecuador	1996–1997	Bucaram	Right-wing
32.	Ecuador	2007–2017	Correa	Left-wing
33.	Germany	1933–1945	Hitler	Right-wing
34.	Greece	2015–2019	Tsipras	Left-wing
35.	Hungary	2010–	Orbán	Right-wing
36.	India	1966–1977	Gandhi	Left-wing
37.	India	2014–	Modi	Right-wing
38.	Indonesia	1945–1948	Sukarno	Left-wing
39.	Indonesia	1949–1966	Sukarno	Left-wing
40.	Indonesia	2014–	Widodo	Left-wing
41.	Israel	1996–1999	Netanyahu	Right-wing
42.	Israel	2009–	Netanyahu	Right-wing
43.	Italy	1922–1943	Mussolini	Right-wing
44.	Italy	1994–1995	Berlusconi	Right-wing
45.	Italy	2001–2006	Berlusconi	Right-wing
46.	Italy	2008–2011	Berlusconi	Right-wing

Panel A. Populist leader spell (coded dataset) – continued				
No.	Country	Years	Leader	Left/Right
47.	Italy	2018–	Lega/M5S	Right-wing
48.	Japan	2001–2006	Koizumi	Right-wing
49.	Mexico	1934–1940	Cárdenas	Left-wing
50.	Mexico	1970–1976	Echeverría	Left-wing
51.	Mexico	2018–	López Obrador	Left-wing
52.	New Zealand	1975–1984	Muldoon	Right-wing
53.	Peru	1985–1990	García	Left-wing
54.	Peru	1990–2000	Fujimori	Right-wing
55.	Philippines	1998–2001	Estrada	Left-wing
56.	Philippines	2016–	Duterte	Right-wing
57.	Poland	2005–2007	Kaczyński/PiS	Right-wing
58.	Poland	2015–	PiS (J. Kaczyński)	Right-wing
59.	Slovakia	1990–1991	Mečiar	Right-wing
60.	Slovakia	1992–1994	Mečiar	Right-wing
61.	Slovakia	1994–1998	Mečiar	Right-wing
62.	Slovakia	2006–2010	Fico	Left-wing
63.	Slovakia	2012–2018	Fico	Left-wing
64.	South Africa	2009–2018	Zuma	Left-wing
65.	South Korea	2003–2008	Roh	Right-wing
66.	Taiwan	2000–2008	Chen	Right-wing
67.	Thailand	2001–2006	Shinawatra	Right-wing
68.	Turkey	2003–	Erdoğan	Right-wing
69.	United Kingdom	2019–	Johnson	Right-wing
70.	United States	2017–	Trump	Right-wing
71.	Venezuela	1999–2013	Chávez	Left-wing
72.	Venezuela	2013–	Maduro	Left-wing

Panel B. Populist episodes (for econometric analysis)			
No.	Leader	Episode	Sample
1.	Yrigoyen	1928–1930	Extended
2.	Perón	1946–1955	Core
3.	Perón-Martínez	1973–1976	Core
4.	Menem	1989–1999	Core
5.	Kirchner-Fernández	2003–2015	Core
6.	Estenssoro-Zuazo	1952–1964	Core
7.	Morales	2006–2019	Extended
8.	Vargas	1930–1945	Extended
9.	Vargas	1951–1954	Core
10.	Collor	1990–1992	Core
11.	Bolsonaro	2019–	Extended
12.	Borisov	2009–	Extended
13.	Alessandri-Ibáñez	1920–1938	Extended
14.	Ibáñez	1952–1958	Core
15.	Velasco	1934–1935	Extended
16.	Velasco	1952–1956	Core
17.	Velasco	1960–1961	Core
18.	Velasco	1968–1972	Core
19.	Bucaram	1996–1997	Core
20.	Correa	2007–2017	Extended
21.	Hitler	1933–1945	Extended

Panel A. Populist leader spell (coded dataset) – continued				
No.	Country	Years	Leader	Left/Right
22.	Tsipras	2015–2019	Extended	
23.	Orbán	2010–	Extended	
24.	Gandhi	1966–1977	Core	
25.	Modi	2014–	Extended	
26.	Widodo	2014–	Extended	
27.	Netanyahu	1996–1999	Core	
28.	Netanyahu	2009–	Extended	
29.	Mussolini	1922–1943	Extended	
30.	Berlusconi	1994–1995	Core	
31.	Berlusconi	2001–2011	Core	
32.	Lega/M5S	2018–	Extended	
33.	Koizumi	2001–2006	Core	
34.	Cárdenas	1934–1940	Extended	
35.	Echeverría	1970–1976	Core	
36.	López Obrador	2018–	Extended	
37.	Muldoon	1975–1984	Core	
38.	García	1985–1990	Core	
39.	Fujimori	1990–2000	Core	
40.	Estrada	1998–2001	Core	
41.	Duterte	2016–	Extended	
42.	Kaczyński/PiS	2005–2007	Extended	
43.	PiS (J. Kaczyński)	2015–	Extended	
44.	Mečiar	1990–1998	Core	
45.	Fico	2006–2018	Extended	
46.	Zuma	2009–2018	Extended	
47.	Roh	2003–2008	Core	
48.	Chen	2000–2008	Core	
49.	Shinawatra	2001–2006	Core	
50.	Erdoğan	2003–	Core	
51.	Johnson	2019–	Extended	
52.	Trump	2017–	Extended	
53.	Chávez-Maduro	1999–	Core	

Notes: Panel A: Dates/names from Archigos (Goemans, Gleditsch, and Chiozza 2009) until December 2015 and own coding based on Wikipedia from January 2016 to December 2020. Panel B: Spells two years or closer together by the same populist (or two populists with similar ideology) are connected. "–" = episode excluded because it starts during world war (1914–1918 or 1939–1945). Core sample: starting years 1946–2004. Extended sample: all other episodes.

Table 2: Growth Rate—Years after Populists Come to Power versus Normal Years

5-year aftermath

	(1)	(2)	(3)
Populist leader	-0.97**	-1.01**	-0.97**
	(0.41)	(0.41)	(0.43)
R^2	0.001	0.174	0.189
Observations	4249	4249	3205

15-year aftermath

	(1)	(2)	(3)
Populist leader	-1.04***	-0.81***	-0.73***
	(0.22)	(0.25)	(0.26)
R^2	0.004	0.174	0.189
Observations	4249	4249	3205

Table 3: Characteristics of the Treated Unit, Synthetic Control, and Donor Pool Countries before the Populist Treatment

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$TABLE3$

Predictor	Treated	Synthetic	DonorPool
GDP	–0.110	–0.116	–0.180
Institutions	–0.637	–0.528	–0.370
Inflation	0.251	0.197	0.160
Banking crises	0.375	0.371	0.203
Sovereign debt crises	0.174	0.168	0.071

Figures

Figure 1: Populists in Power: Share of Countries in Sample

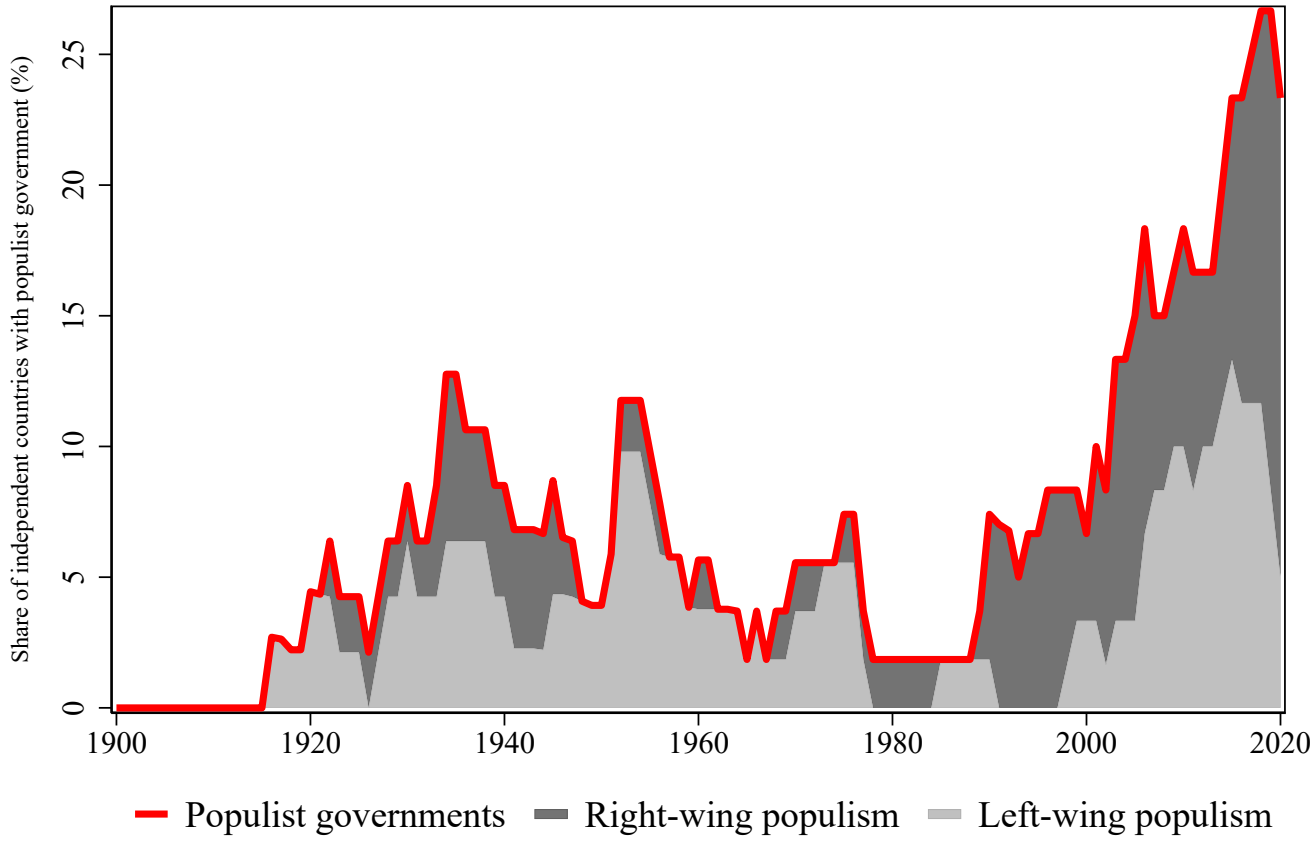

Figure 1. Populists in Power: Share of Countries in Sample

Figure 2: Populist Leader Spells by Country

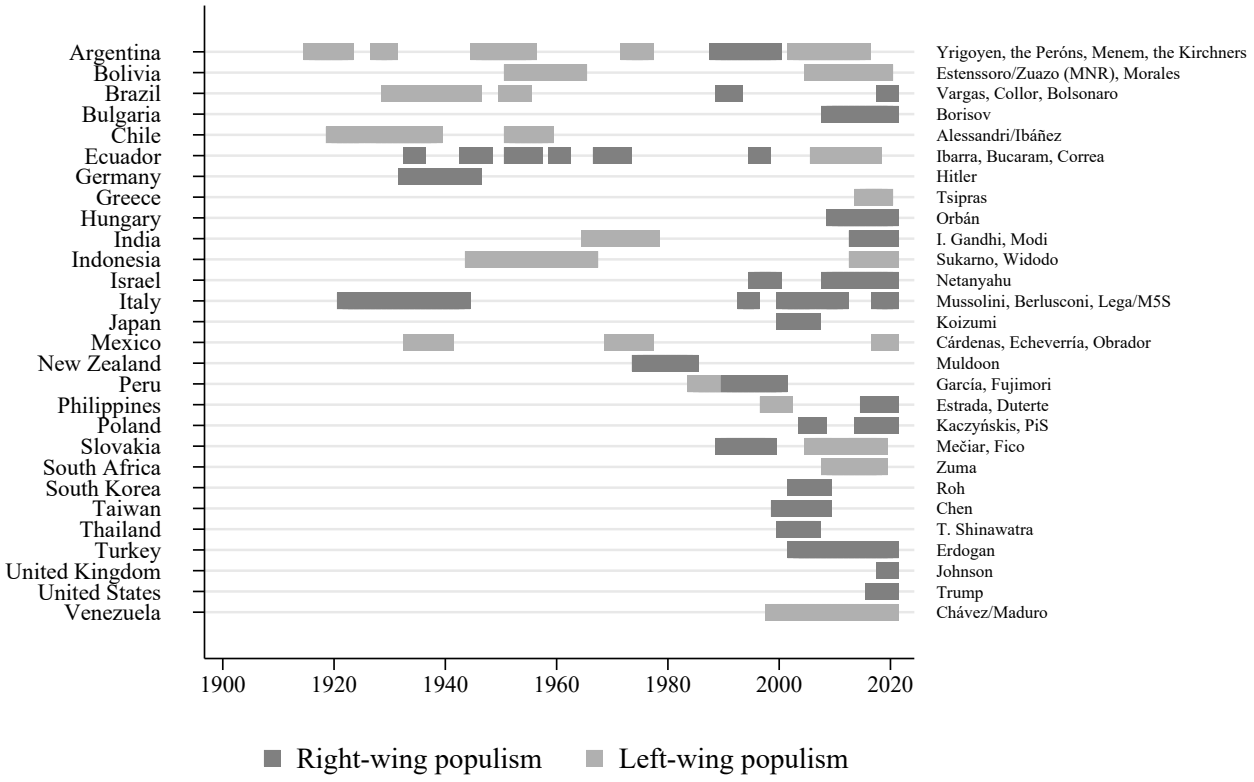

Figure 2. Populist Leader Spells by Country

Figure 3: Average Annualized Growth Gap after Populists Come to Power

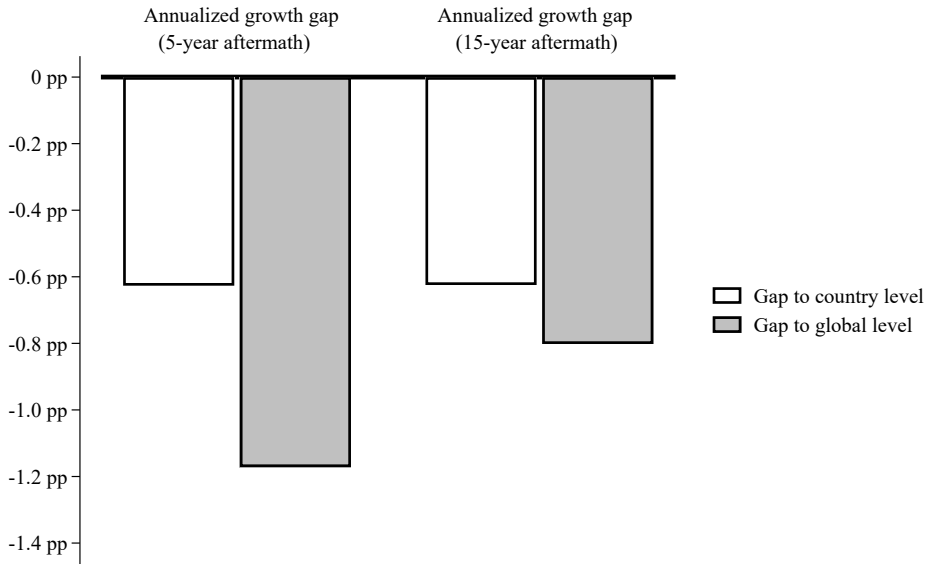

Figure 3. Average Annualized Growth Gap after Populists Come to Power

Figure 4: Real GDP Paths after Populist Governments Enter into Office: Local Projections

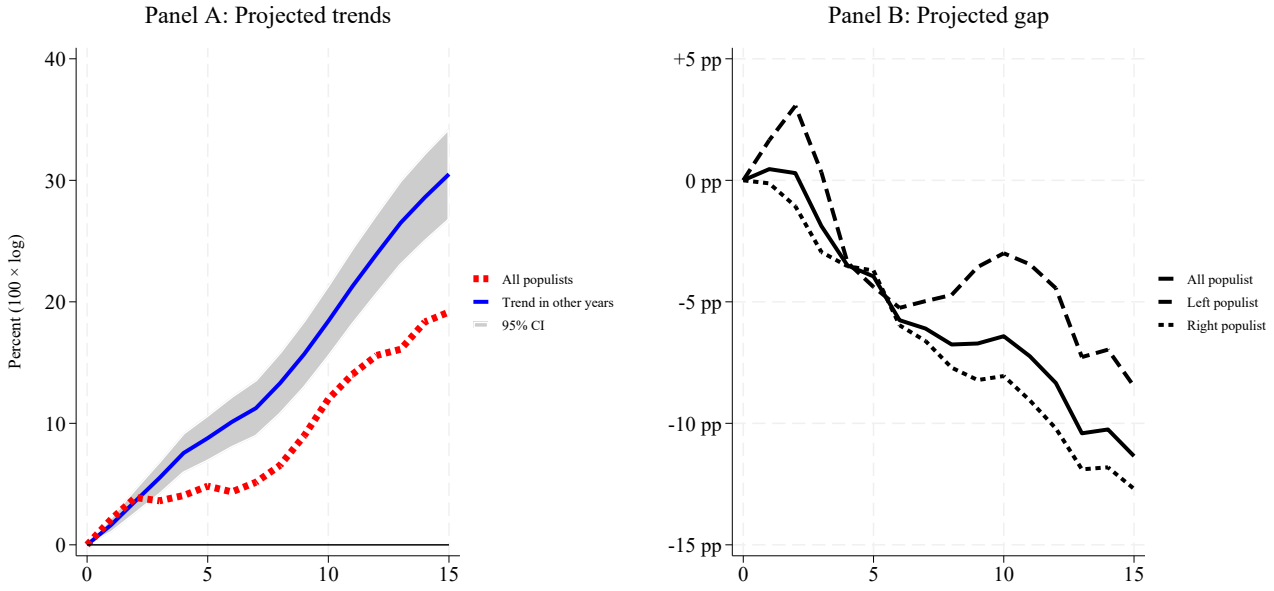

Figure 4. Real GDP Paths after Populist Governments Enter into Office: Local Projections

Figure 5: GDP after Populist Comes to Power: IPWRA-LPs

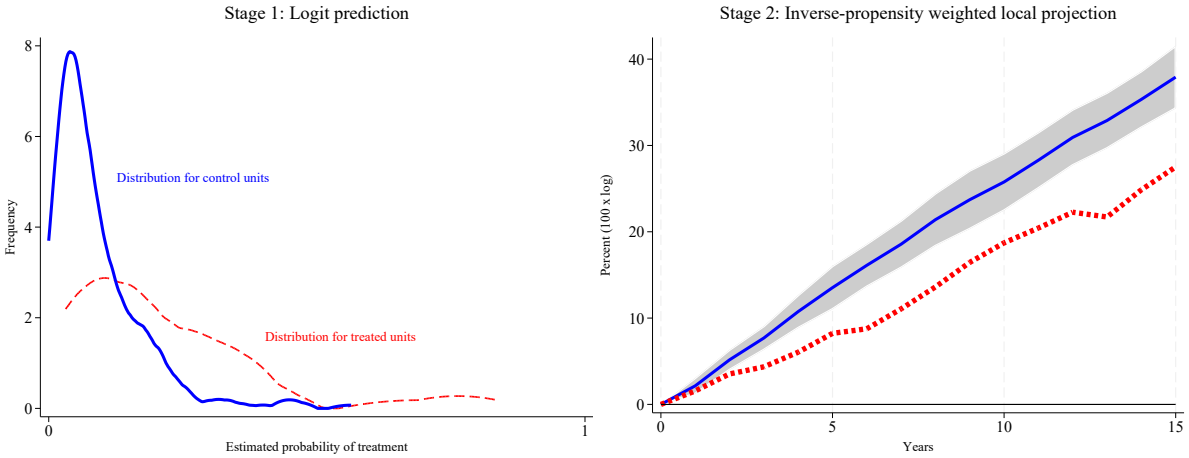

Figure 5. GDP after Populist Comes to Power: IPWRA-LPs

Figure 6: Baseline Results

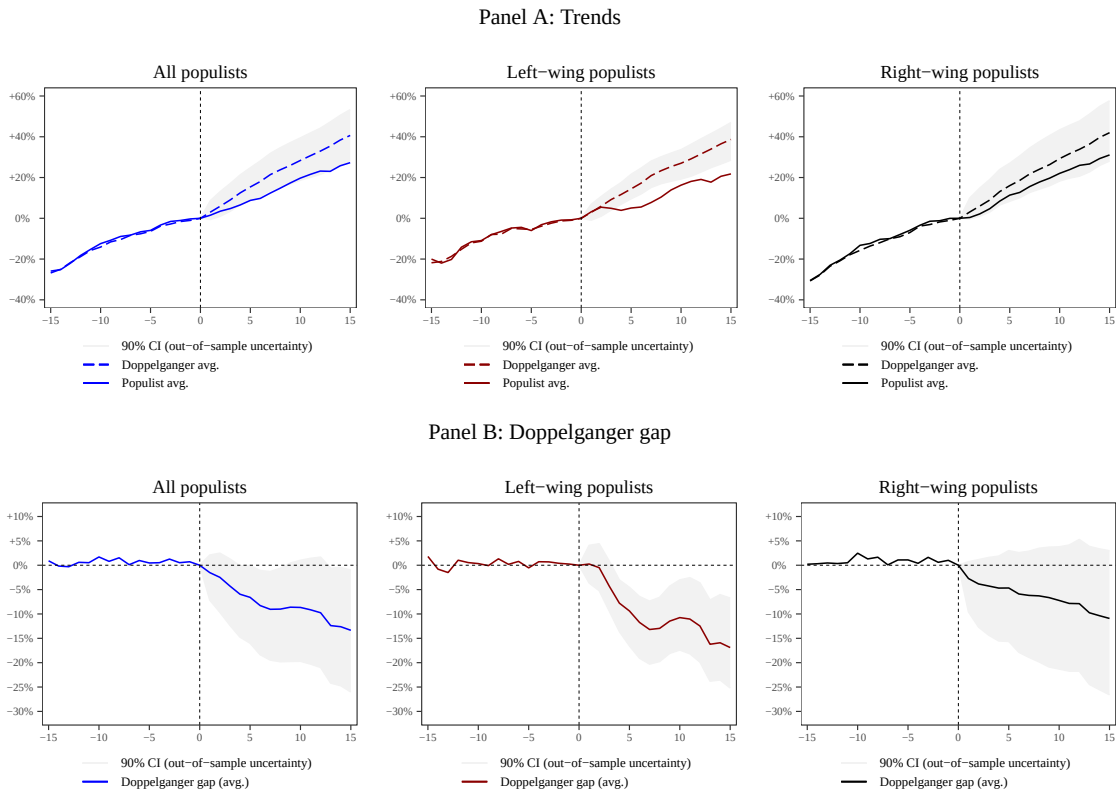

Figure 6. Baseline Results

Figure 7: Country Placebo Tests with Real GDP

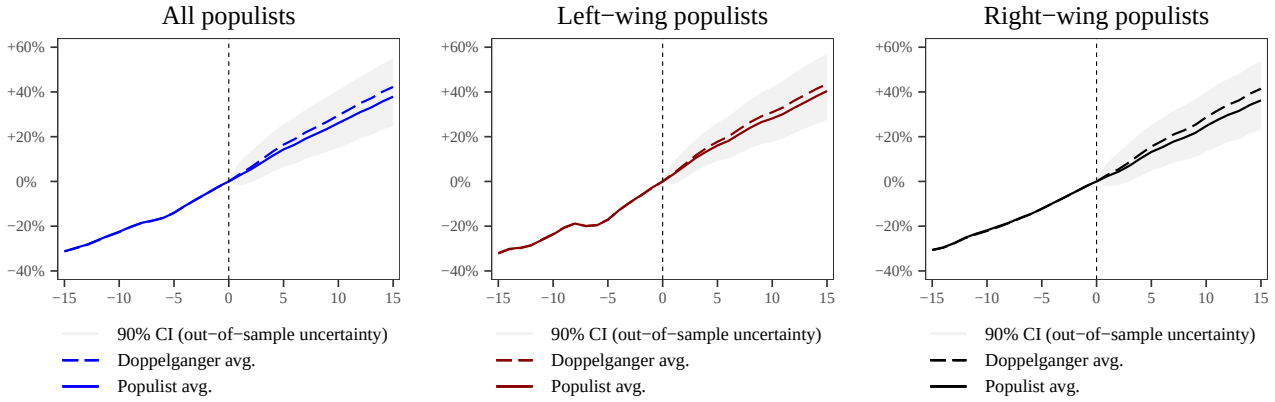

Figure 7. Country Placebo Tests with Real GDP: Randomly Assigning the Entry of the Populist Government into Office to Other Countries

Figure 8: Time Placebo Test with Real GDP

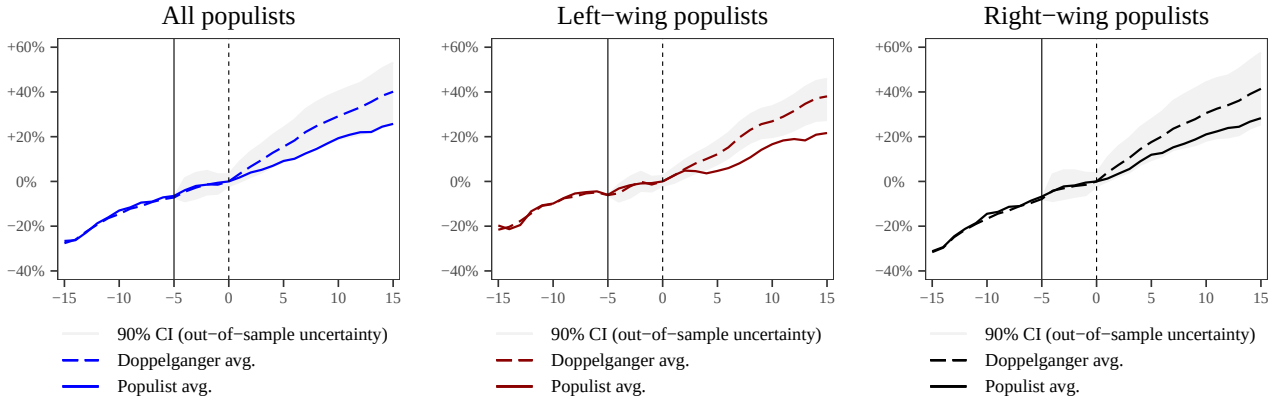

Figure 8. Time Placebo Test with Real GDP: Five-Year Backward Shift of the Entry of the Populist Government into Office

Figure 9: Multiple Treated Units Adjustment via Penalization

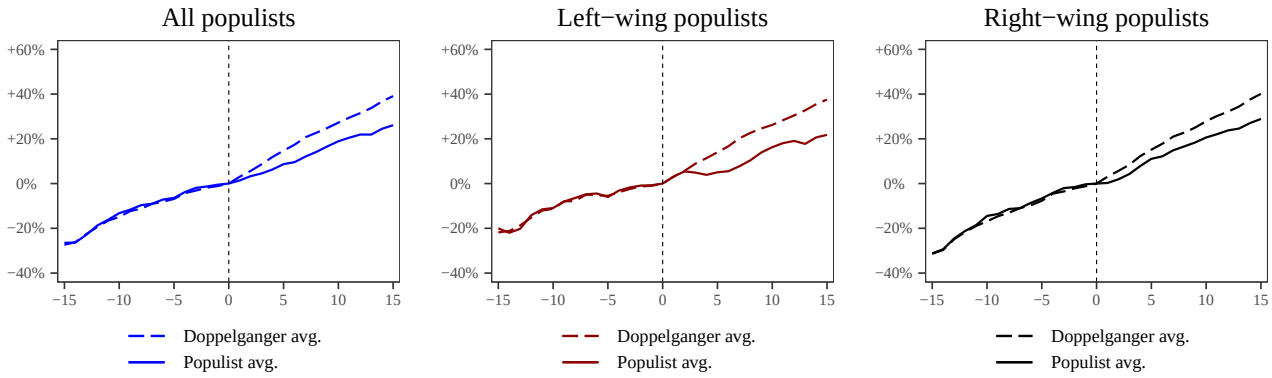

Figure 9. Multiple Treated Units Adjustment via Penalization

Figure 10: Multiple Treated Units Adjustment via Partially Pooled SCs

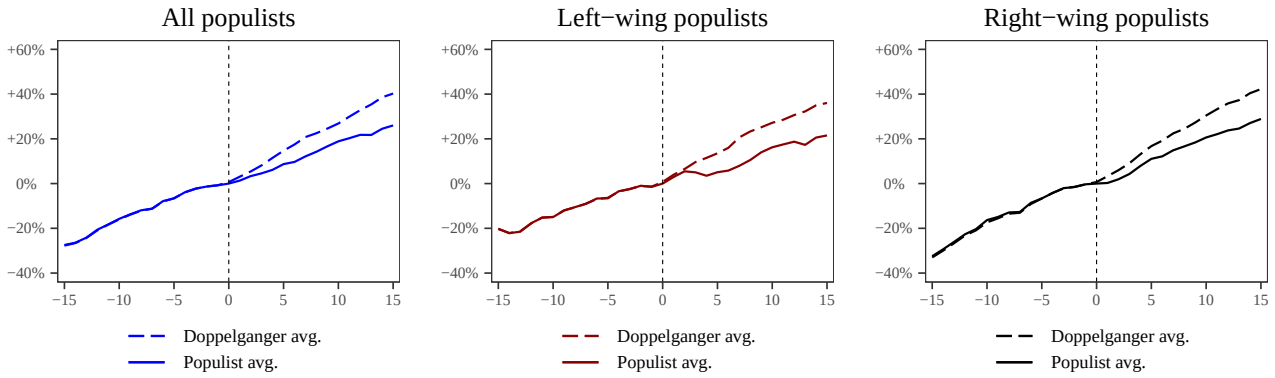

Figure 10. Multiple Treated Units Adjustment via Partially Pooled SCs

Figure 11: Income Inequality after Populists Take Power (±15 Years)

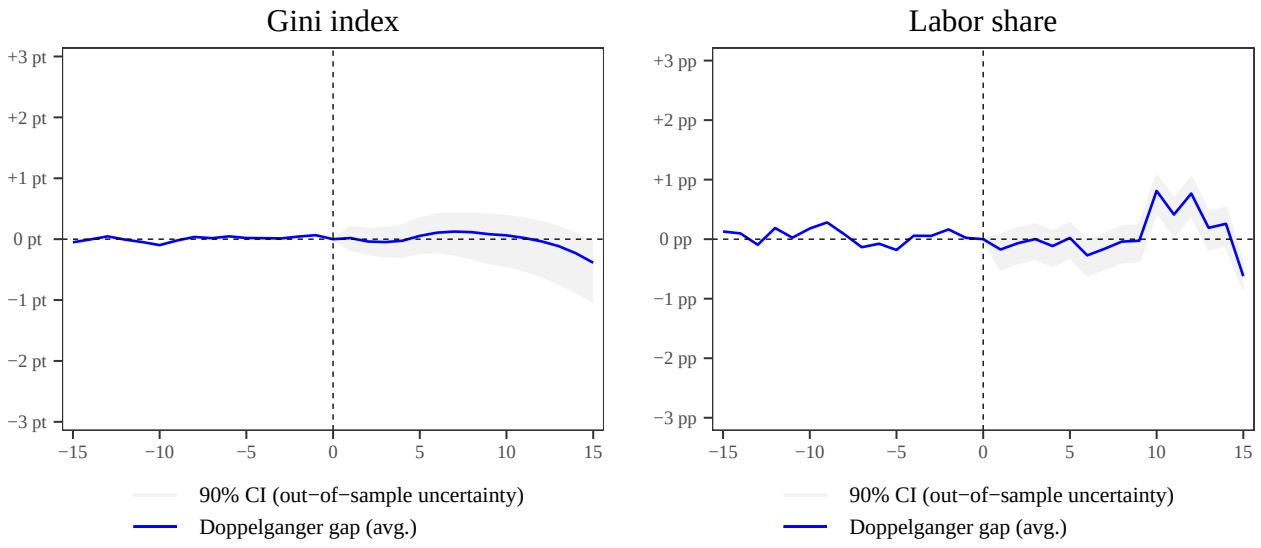

Figure 11. Income Inequality after Populists Take Power (±15 Years)

Figure 12: Trade and Financial Openness after Populists Take Power (±15 Years)

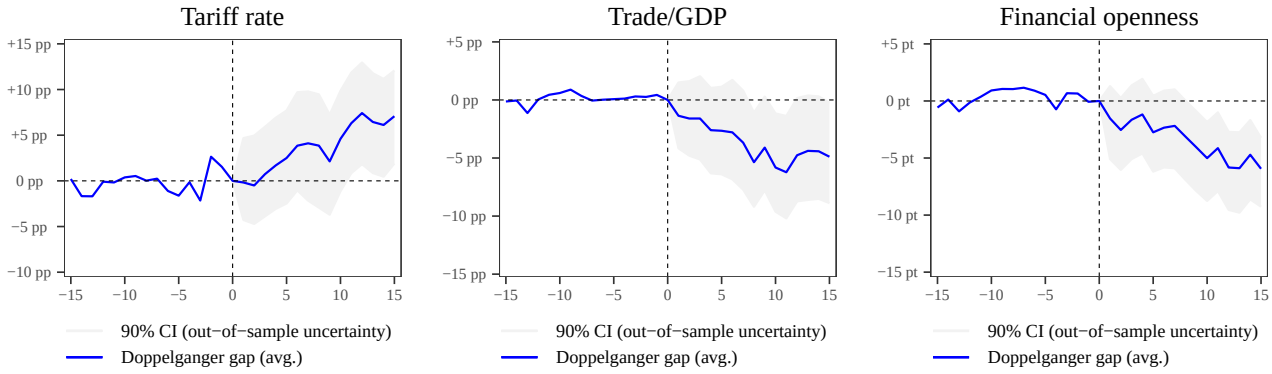

Figure 12. Trade and Financial Openness after Populists Take Power (±15 Years)

Figure 13: Macro Outcomes after Populists Take Power

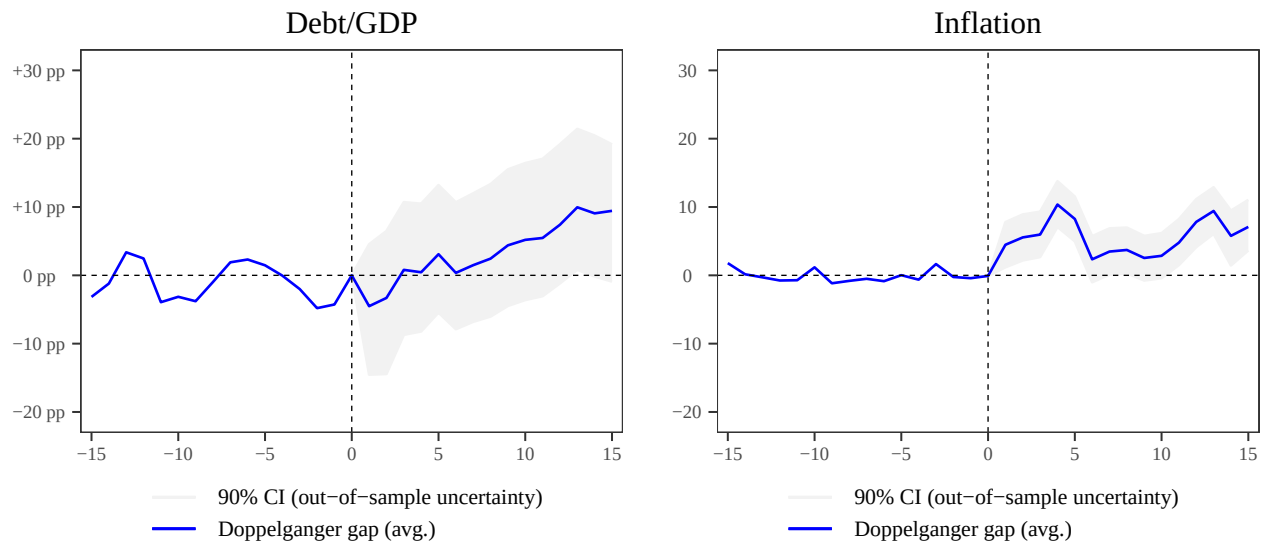

Figure 13. Macro Outcomes after Populists Take Power

Figure 14: Institutions (Doppelgänger Gap) after Populists Take Power (±15 years)

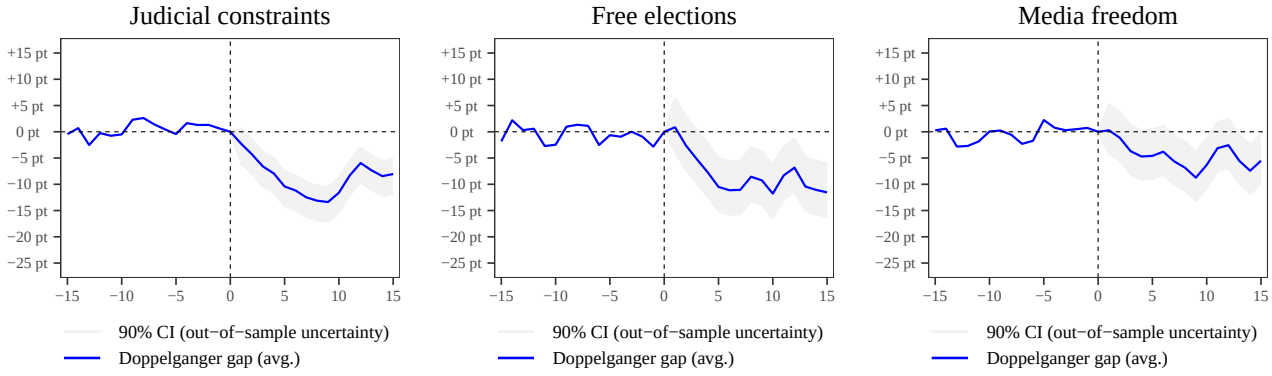

Figure 14. Institutions (Doppelgänger Gap) after Populists Take Power (±15 years)